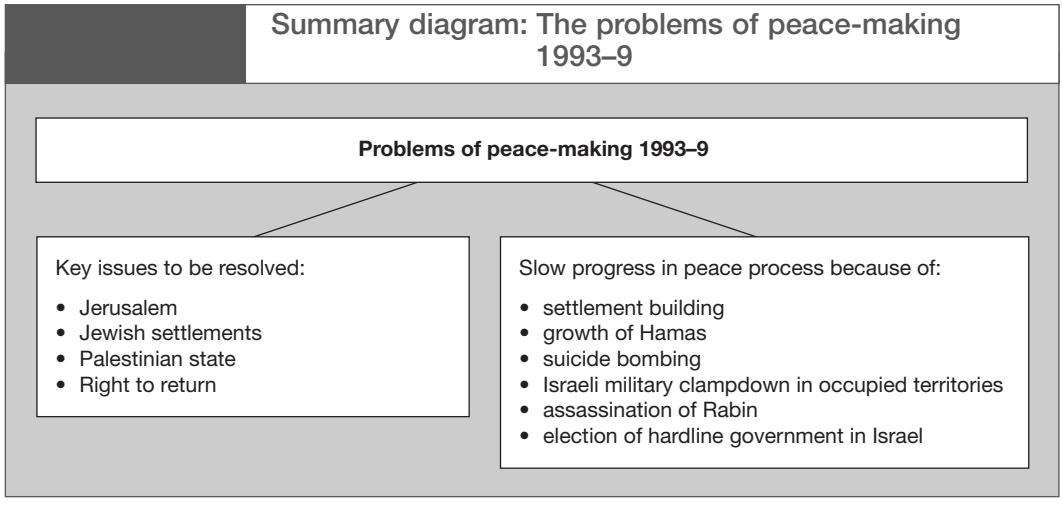
Summary diagram: The problems of peace-making 1993–9



3 | The Second *Intifada* and After 2000–8

Clinton's final bid for peace, Camp David 2000

Key question
What was the outcome of the talks at Camp David?

In 1999 there was yet another change of government in Israel and, this time, the Israelis elected a more moderate government led by Ehud Barak. The US President, Bill Clinton, tried to revive the peace process. In July 2000, he invited the Israeli and PLO leaders to Camp David. For several days the two sides were locked in discussion, with the Americans trying to steer the negotiations towards a peaceful outcome. Barak offered the Palestinians a deal that would have given them Gaza and most of the West Bank. And he went further than any previous Israeli Prime Minister by agreeing to partition the city of Jerusalem. But the obstacles to peace proved too great. In particular, the issues of who controlled the holy sites of Jerusalem and of the right of Palestinian refugees to return to Israel could not be resolved. The talks ended with no significant progress achieved. Many in the West blamed Arafat, accusing him of rejecting a generous deal. Others defended him: how could the PLO accept a peace deal that did not grant them complete control of east Jerusalem, which was mainly Arab, as their capital?

Key dates
Camp David peace negotiations: 2000

Beginning of the second *Intifada*: 2000

The second *Intifada* 2000

Key question
What were the origins of the second *Intifada*?

On 28 September 2000 the Israeli politician, Ariel Sharon, made a tour of what Jews call Temple Mount in Jerusalem. To Muslims, this area is known as the Dome of the Rock (see the photograph on page 12 showing the golden dome of the al-Aqsa mosque) and is their third holiest site after Mecca and Medina. Sharon obviously expected to cause trouble as he was accompanied by over 1000 police! He certainly got it. The visit was seen as highly provocative by Palestinians. Many saw it as a threat to impose Israeli control over the holy sites. Whatever the intentions, demonstrations followed and Israeli troops shot seven Palestinians